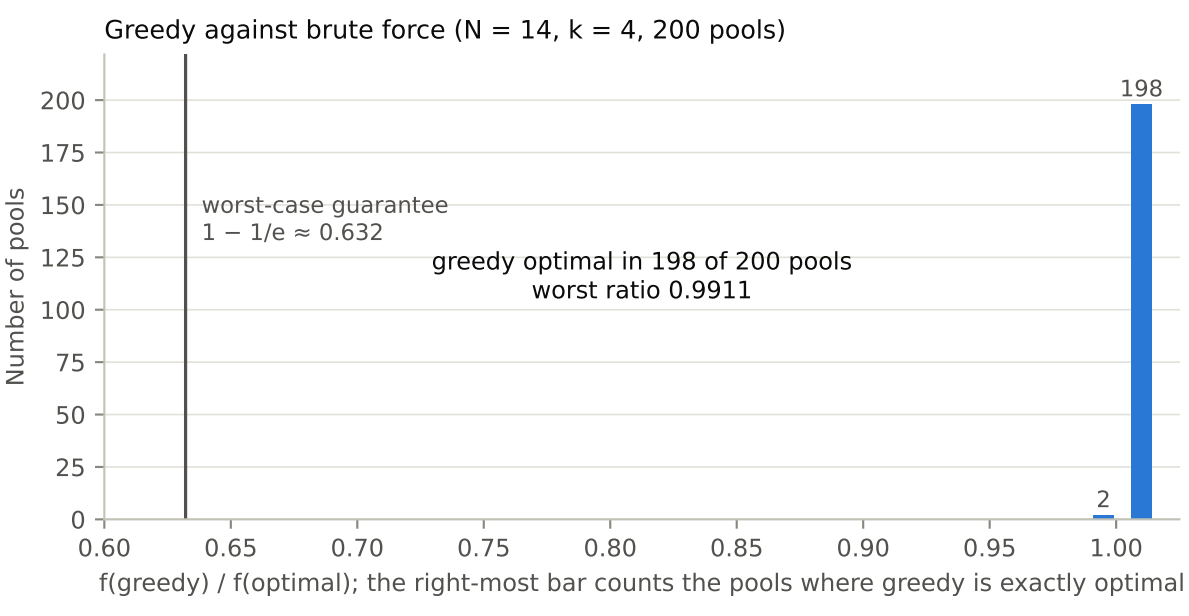
Greedy against brute force (N = 14, k = 4, 200 pools)
Number of pools
0
25
50
75
100
125
150
175
200
worst-case guarantee
1 − 1/e ≈ 0.632
greedy optimal in 198 of 200 pools
worst ratio 0.9911
198
2
0.60
0.65
0.70
0.75
0.80
0.85
0.90
0.95
1.00
f(greedy) / f(optimal); the right-most bar counts the pools where greedy is exactly optimal